ISSUE No XIII

📅 AUGUST 31, 2026

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ISSUE
No
XIII

AUGUST 31, 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 State of exception: On India, the UN CERD report
THE HINDU | Human Rights & International Law — Page 03

02 Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship
THE HINDU | Sports / Test Cricket — Page 06

03 As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge
THE INDIAN EXPRESS | Environmental Policy & Climate Change — Page 09

04 Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability
THE INDIAN EXPRESS | Technology & Digital Regulation — Page 12

05

06

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>
> *-SARAH J. MAAS*

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THE HINDU

HUMAN RIGHTS & INTERNATIONAL LAW

State of exception: On India, the UN CERD report

> *India must heed international concerns on discrimination rather than evading accountability through administrative technicalities.*

August 31, 2026 · 3 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

In its first review by the U.N. Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD) since 2007, India has **elicited**[1] an expression of "grave concern" about reports of the law enforcement **apparatus**[2] **resorting to**[3] violence — physical and otherwise — against minority ethnic and ethno-religious groups, Dalits, and non-citizens over the years. The Committee also noted that India, which **ratified**[4] the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination in 1968, has not provided detailed and updated information about the state's inquiries and **sanctions**[5] arising from allegations of such violence. While the government has told CERD that caste bias falls outside Article 1 of the convention because caste is not **synonymous with**[6] race, CERD has allowed all forms of discrimination based on inherited status. The Committee's concerns also span the practice of manual cleaning of sewers despite a law banning it; hate speech against, poor living conditions of, and the mass **refoulement**[7] of Rohingya Muslims; the mass **deprivation**[8] of citizenship via the National Register of Citizens; large-scale deletions from the Special Intensive Revisions of electoral rolls; the government's use of the FCRA, UAPA, AFSPA, and PMLA instruments to **hamper**[9] the work of civil society organisations; the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita not **expressly**[10] criminalising racist hate speech; and the Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act **exempting**[11] "national security" projects from consultative decision-making.

Given these issues and the **fragmented**[12] **recourse**[13] available, the lack of suitably **disaggregated**[14] data on **disenfranchised**[15] communities, including due to a much-delayed Census and the slow release of NCRB data, has **transcended**[16] the bounds of administrative **lethargy**[17] to actively **impeding**[18] independent checks of India's claims about fighting caste- and faith-based discrimination. In fact, India has been implementing "special measures" based on 2011 Census data, which could mask a **regression**[19] in the socioeconomic status of Scheduled Tribes and Adivasis. Together with the Global Alliance of National Human Rights Institutions recommending the downgrade of the NHRC last year, following the government appointing police officers to investigative roles and a lack of **pluralism**[20], CERD is effectively **stepping into a vacuum**[21]. The road ahead remains clear, from restoring the NHRC's independence and criminalising hate speech to supportive **affirmative action**[22], collecting and publishing **disaggregated**[14] data, and improving the transparency of the electoral roll revisions, and strengthening enforcement overall. But if the government's attempted use of a **technicality**[23] to keep the issues of 200 million Dalits a "domestic matter" and avoid international accountability — and its dismissal of CERD's concerns as politically motivated — is any guide, the task continues to fall to civil society to exert influence in multilateral **fora**[24] and sustain political, legal, and administrative resistance to government choices that **normalise**[25] India's sadly widespread culture of discrimination of all sorts.

★ VOCABULARY 101

1	**elicited**	(Verb)	Evoked	प्राप्त किया / उत्पन्न किया
2	**apparatus**	(Noun)	Machinery	तंत्र / उपकरण
3	**resorting to**	(Phrasal verb)	Turning to	का सहारा लेना
4	**ratified**	(Verb)	Approved	पुष्टि की / अनुमोदित किया
5	**sanctions**	(Noun)	Penalties	दंडात्मक प्रतिबंध
6	**synonymous with**	(Adjective)	Equivalent to	के समानार्थक / पर्याय
7	**refoulement**	(Noun)	Forced return	शरणार्थियों का जबरन निष्कासन
8	**deprivation**	(Noun)	Loss	वंचन / अभाव
9	**hamper**	(Verb)	Hinder	बाधा डालना
10	**expressly**	(Adverb)	Explicitly	स्पष्ट रूप से
11	**exempting**	(Verb)	Excusing	छूट देना
12	**fragmented**	(Adjective)	Disjointed	खंडित / बिखरा हुआ
13	**recourse**	(Noun)	Remedy	उपाय / सहारा
14	**disaggregated**	(Adjective)	Itemised	पृथक-पृथक / उप-विभाजित
15	**disenfranchised**	(Adjective)	Marginalised	अधिकार-वंचित
16	**transcended**	(Verb)	Exceeded	से परे चला गया / पार कर गया
17	**lethargy**	(Noun)	Sluggishness	सुस्ती / आलस्य
18	**impeding**	(Verb)	Obstructing	अड़चन डालना
19	**regression**	(Noun)	Decline	पतन / अवनति
20	**pluralism**	(Noun)	Diversity	बहुलतावाद
21	**stepping into a vacuum**	(Verb)	Filling a void	रिक्तता को भरना
22	**affirmative action**	(Noun)	Positive discrimination	सकारात्मक कार्रवाई / आरक्षण
23	**technicality**	(Noun)	Formal detail	औपचारिक बारीकी / तकनीकी बहाना
24	**fora**	(Noun)	Platforms	मंच / सभाएँ
25	**normalise**	(Verb)	Make standard	सामान्य बनाना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: State of exception: On India, the UN CERD report

THE HINDU | HUMAN RIGHTS & INTERNATIONAL LAW

EDITORIAL STANCE

CRITICAL

“fault-finding and warning”

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author adopts a critical and admonitory tone to censure the Indian government's defensive posturing regarding systemic caste and religious discrimination. By highlighting the UN CERD findings alongside delayed census data and weakened human rights watchdogs, the editorial underscores an institutional regression in safeguarding minorities. The author ultimately urges civil society and international bodies to hold the state accountable against the normalisation of prejudice.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

17 WORDS

01	**elicited** VERB NEUTRAL	प्राप्त किया / उत्पन्न किया Evoked or drew out a specific reaction, answer, or response from someone.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'extract' + 'solicit' — drawing out a specific reaction or reply.	**SYNONYMS** • evoked • extracted • obtained	**ANTONYMS** • suppressed • repressed • concealed
02	**apparatus** NOUN NEUTRAL	तंत्र / उपकरण The technical equipment or complex organisational structure of a government or system.	**MEMORY HOOK** Apparatus sounds like 'appliances' or the internal mechanism running a system.	**SYNONYMS** • machinery • structure • organisation	**ANTONYMS** • disorganisation • individual • chaos
03	**ratified** VERB POSITIVE	पुष्टि की / अनुमोदित किया Gave formal consent or validation to a treaty or agreement, making it officially valid.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Rate' + 'certified' — giving formal written approval to make an agreement valid.	**SYNONYMS** • endorsed • validated • confirmed	**ANTONYMS** • rejected • repudiated • annulled
04	**sanctions** NOUN NEGATIVE	दंडात्मक प्रतिबंध Threatened penalties or punitive measures imposed for disobeying a law or rule.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sanctions act like strict 'factions' enforcing punishments against violations.	**SYNONYMS** • penalties • punishments • embargoes	**ANTONYMS** • rewards • incentives • permissions
05	**deprivation** NOUN NEGATIVE	वंचन / अभाव The damaging lack of material benefits or fundamental rights considered essential.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Deprive' means to strip away; deprivation is the state of being stripped of rights.	**SYNONYMS** • dispossession • divestment • denial	**ANTONYMS** • endowment • provision • enrichment
06	**hamper** VERB NEGATIVE	बाधा डालना To hinder, obstruct, or impede the progress or free movement of someone or something.	**MEMORY HOOK** Trying to run while carrying a heavy gift 'hamper' will slow down and block you.	**SYNONYMS** • impede • obstruct • thwart	**ANTONYMS** • facilitate • assist • expedite
07	**expressly** ADVERB NEUTRAL	स्पष्ट रूप से In an explicit, clear, and unambiguous manner for a specific purpose.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like an 'express' train moving directly and clearly to the destination without ambiguity.	**SYNONYMS** • explicitly • categorically • definitely	**ANTONYMS** • implicitly • vaguely • ambiguously
08	**exempting** VERB NEUTRAL	छूट देना Freeing or releasing a person or body from an obligation or liability imposed on others.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Ex' (out) + 'empty' — leaving someone out of an obligation.	**SYNONYMS** • excusing • releasing • absolving	**ANTONYMS** • subjecting • obligating • binding
09	**fragmented** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	खंडित / बिखरा हुआ Broken down into small, disconnected, or isolated parts.	**MEMORY HOOK** Made of 'fragments' — broken pieces that are scattered and not unified.	**SYNONYMS** • disjointed • splintered • disconnected	**ANTONYMS** • unified • integrated • cohesive
10	**disaggregated** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पृथक-पृथक / उप-विभाजित Separated into its constituent elements or smaller component sub-groups for detailed analysis.	**MEMORY HOOK** Opposite of 'aggregate' (total mass) — split into distinct component sub-categories.	**SYNONYMS** • itemised • segmented • differentiated	**ANTONYMS** • aggregated • consolidated • combined

11	**disenfranchised** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	**अधिकार-वंचित** Deprived of civil or legal rights, especially the right to vote or participate politically.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Dis' (deprive) + 'franchise' (right to vote/rights) = stripped of constitutional power.	**SYNONYMS** • marginalised • disempowered • oppressed	**ANTONYMS** • enfranchised • empowered • privileged
12	**transcended** VERB NEUTRAL	**से परे चला गया / पार कर गया** Surpassed, exceeded, or went beyond the typical range or limits of something.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Trans' (across) + 'ascend' (climb) — rising above or going beyond standard limits.	**SYNONYMS** • surpassed • exceeded • outstripped	**ANTONYMS** • trailed • succumbed • confined
13	**lethargy** NOUN NEGATIVE	**सुस्ती / आलस्य** A state of sluggishness, inactivity, or a lack of energy and administrative initiative.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'lazy energy' — complete lack of enthusiasm or slow bureaucratic action.	**SYNONYMS** • inertia • torpor • sluggishness	**ANTONYMS** • vigour • alacrity • dynamism
14	**impeding** VERB NEGATIVE	**अड़चन डालना** Delaying or preventing someone or something by obstructing or hindering their progress.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Im' + 'ped' (foot) — putting an obstacle around the foot to prevent movement.	**SYNONYMS** • obstructing • hindering • curbing	**ANTONYMS** • advancing • facilitating • promoting
15	**regression** NOUN NEGATIVE	**पतन / अवनति** A return to a previous, less advanced, or worse state of development.	**MEMORY HOOK** Opposite of 'progression' — moving backward into a worse condition.	**SYNONYMS** • deterioration • retrogression • decline	**ANTONYMS** • progression • advancement • improvement
16	**technicality** NOUN NEGATIVE	**औपचारिक बारीकी / तकनीकी बहाना** A petty point of law or a small formal rule used strategically to evade broader obligations.	**MEMORY HOOK** Focusing only on a small 'tech' or legal rule to evade the broader substantive reality.	**SYNONYMS** • formal detail • subtlety • quibble	**ANTONYMS** • substance • essence • core
17	**normalise** VERB NEGATIVE	**सामान्य बनाना** To cause something previously considered unacceptable or unusual to be regarded as standard.	**MEMORY HOOK** Making something abnormal or toxic seem 'normal' through repeated occurrence.	**SYNONYMS** • standardise • legitimise • institutionalise	**ANTONYMS** • stigmatise • denounce • aberrate

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · STATE OF EXCEPTION: ON INDIA, THE UN CERD REPORT

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	**recourse** NOUN NEUTRAL	**उपाय / सहारा** A source of help, legal remedy, or relief in a difficult or unjust situation.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Re-course' = choosing an alternative course of action to seek legal help.	**SYNONYMS** • remedy • redress • resort	**ANTONYMS** • helplessness • deadlock • impasse
02	**pluralism** NOUN POSITIVE	**बहुलतावाद** A condition or system in which multiple distinct ethnic, religious, or political groups coexist.	**MEMORY HOOK** Root word 'plural' (many) — a system where many different groups coexist peacefully.	**SYNONYMS** • diversity • multiculturalism • coexistence	**ANTONYMS** • monism • uniformity • homogeneity

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

2 TERMS

01	**resorting to** PHRASAL VERB NEGATIVE	**का सहारा लेना** Turning to and adopting a particular, often undesirable, course of action when other options fail.	**MEMORY HOOK** When nothing else works, you visit the last 'resort' out of desperation.	**SYNONYMS** • turning to • employing • adopting	**ANTONYMS** • abstaining from • avoiding • shunning
02	**synonymous with** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	**के समानार्थक / पर्याय** Having the same or nearly the same meaning; closely associated with another idea.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Synonym' means the same meaning; hence, closely associated or interchangeable with.	**SYNONYMS** • equivalent to • interchangeable with • identical to	**ANTONYMS** • distinct from • opposite to • incompatible with

IDIOMS & PHRASES

2 TERMS

01	**stepping into a vacuum** VERB NEUTRAL	रिक्तता को भरना Taking charge, intervening, or asserting authority where there is an absence of control or leadership.	**MEMORY HOOK** A vacuum is empty space; stepping in means filling the absence of leadership or action.	**SYNONYMS** • filling the void • bridging the gap • taking over	**ANTONYMS** • withdrawing • vacating • retreating
02	**affirmative action** NOUN POSITIVE	सकारात्मक कार्रवाई / आरक्षण Policies and practices designed to favour members of a disadvantaged group who have suffered discrimination.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Affirming' support through direct state 'action' to uplift historically suppressed classes.	**SYNONYMS** • positive discrimination • remedial policy • equal opportunity measu	**ANTONYMS** • discrimination • disenfranchisement • exclusion

FOREIGN WORDS 2 TERMS

01	**refoulement** NOUN NEGATIVE	शरणार्थियों का जबरन निष्कासन The forcible return of refugees or asylum seekers to a country where they are likely to face persecution.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'return through foul means' — forcibly driving refugees back to danger.	**SYNONYMS** • forced repatriation • deportation • expulsion	**ANTONYMS** • asylum • shelter • protection
02	**fora** NOUN NEUTRAL	मंच / सभाएँ Public meeting places, assemblies, or media outlets for open discussion and debate.	**MEMORY HOOK** Latin plural of 'forum' — multiple platforms or arenas for open debate.	**SYNONYMS** • forums • platforms • arenas	**ANTONYMS** • seclusion • isolation • privacy

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship →

THE HINDU SPORTS / TEST CRICKET

Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship

> *India's drawn series in Sri Lanka complicates their World Test Championship final qualification scenario.*

August 31, 2026 · 2 min read DAILY EDITORIAL READER

This was a triumph that **ironically**[1] suffered the after-effects of a loss. India's 1-0 series victory in the two-Test outing recently in Sri Lanka, in normal circumstances, would have been seen as a positive. However, in the race for key points in the ICC World Test Championship (WTC) cycle, the ideal India-centric result would have been a **clean sweep**[2] at 2-0. But with Dhananjaya de Silva's men **thwarting**[3] India's **bid for**[4] a win in the second Test at Colombo's Sinhalese Sports Club Ground, and forcing a draw, the visitors continue to occupy the fifth slot in the WTC rankings. It is a position one below Bangladesh after the eastern neighbour secured a 1-1 draw against Australia in the series **Down Under**[5]. If a WTC final **berth**[6] has to be secured then India has to do extremely well away against New Zealand and at home against Australia, and then hope that the various **permutations**[7] **cropping up**[8] will be favourable. Shubman Gill's men find themselves in this **piquant**[9] situation due to their **vulnerability**[10] at home, having lost a Test series to South Africa last year. The transition **angst**[11] within the Indian unit is yet to **abate**[12] following the exit of R. Ashwin, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma. Slowly, new heroes are emerging and the results could improve.

Stepping into the Emerald Isle and **hamstrung**[13] by the injured Jasprit Bumrah's absence, India did its homework. A warm-up fixture was won, while some of its players had earlier **turned out**[14] for India A against Sri Lanka A and were ready. When the series commenced with the first Test at **picturesque**[15] Galle, India led from the front and won by 165 runs to secure a 1-0 lead. Devdutt Padikkal's 167 and 44 led the run charts and most

VOCABULARY 101

1. **Ironically** (Adverb)
Paradoxically • व्यंग्यात्मक रूप से / विडंबना से
2. **Clean sweep** (Noun)
Complete victory • पूरी जीत / सूपड़ा साफ
3. **Thwarting** (Verb)
Preventing • नाकाम करना / विफल करना
4. **Bid for** (Noun)
Attempt at • प्रयास करना / दावेदारी
5. **Down Under** (Adverb)
Australia/New Zealand • ऑस्ट्रेलिया या न्यूजीलैंड
6. **Berth** (Noun)
Place/Spot • स्थान / जगह
7. **Permutations** (Noun)
Combinations • संभावित गणनाएँ / फेरबदल
8. **Cropping up** (Verb)
Arising • अचानक प्रकट होना
9. **Piquant** (Adjective)
Tricky/Provocative • दिलचस्प लेकिन पेचीदा / तीखा
10. **Vulnerability** (Noun)
Weakness • संवेदनशीलता / भेद्यता
11. **Angst** (Noun)
Deep anxiety • गहरी चिंता / बेचैनी
12. **Abate** (Verb)
Lessen • कम होना / घटना
13. **Hamstrung** (Verb)
Crippled/Restricted • बाधित / लाचार बना दिया

importantly it also meant that the critical number three spot in the batting order had found an **apt**[16] occupant for now. This is the same position that in the past had featured **pedigreed**[17] men such as Dilip Vengsarkar, Rahul Dravid and Cheteshwar Pujara. Left-arm spinner Manav Suthar too did well and his classical mode is a **throwback**[18] to a gentle past. Sri Lanka's brief resistance **hinged on**[19] Sonal Dinusha, who registered a ton. Soon he would become an **immovable**[20] personality at the batting crease and India learnt it the hard way at Colombo. His twin hundreds helped Sri Lanka erase the **ignominy**[21] of suffering a follow-on and also survive a tense final day to **wrest**[22] a draw. The conclusion felt like a victory for the host and India is now placed in a must-win corner in its future Tests.

14	**Turned out** (Verb)	Appeared/Played • मैदान में उतरे / भाग लिया
15	**Picturesque** (Adjective)	Scenically beautiful • चित्रमय / दर्शनीय
16	**Apt** (Adjective)	Suitable • उचित / सर्वथा योग्य
17	**Pedigreed** (Adjective)	Distinguished • प्रतिष्ठित / उच्च कुल या पृष्ठभूमि वाला
18	**Throwback** (Noun)	Reminder of past • पुरानी याद ताजा करने वाला / पूर्व लक्षण
19	**Hinged on** (Verb)	Depended on • पर निर्भर होना
20	**Immovable** (Adjective)	Unshakeable • अटल / अविचल
21	**Ignominy** (Noun)	Shame/Disgrace • बदनामी / अपमान
22	**Wrest** (Verb)	Snatch/Extract • छीन लेना / संघर्ष करके हासिल करना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Drawn to defeat: On India's chances in the ICC World Test Championship

THE HINDU

SPORTS / TEST CRICKET

EDITORIAL STANCE

ANALYTICAL

"evaluating outcomes and challenges"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author evaluates India's 1-0 series win in Sri Lanka through the lens of the World Test Championship points table, where dropping a match acts as a tactical setback. By examining squad transitions and missed opportunities to sweep the series, the piece underlines the heightened pressure on the team. It concludes that India must deliver flawless performances in upcoming tours to remain in contention for the final.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

13 WORDS

01	**Ironically** ADVERB NEUTRAL	व्यंग्यात्मक रूप से / विडंबना से In a manner that happens contrary to expectations and often seems wryly amusing or contradictory.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of 'Irony'—when what happens is the complete opposite of what you reasonably expect.	SYNONYMS • paradoxically • incongruously • unexpectedly	ANTONYMS • predictably • expectedly • naturally
02	**Thwarting** VERB NEGATIVE	नाकाम करना / विफल करना Preventing someone from accomplishing a purpose or stopping an effort from succeeding.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'throw water' on someone's fiery plan to extinguish and spoil it.	SYNONYMS • foiling • frustrating • impeding	ANTONYMS • aiding • assisting • facilitating
03	**Berth** NOUN POSITIVE	स्थान / जगह A secure position, spot, or place gained in a competition, ranking, or organisation.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like booking a train 'berth' (sleeping spot) gives you a guaranteed seat/position in the tournament.	SYNONYMS • slot • place • position	ANTONYMS • exclusion • elimination • rejection
04	**Permutations** NOUN NEUTRAL	संभावित गणनाएँ / फेरबदल Several different ways in which a set of things can be arranged, ordered, or combined.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of maths: 'permutations and combinations'—all the different variations of possible scenarios.	SYNONYMS • variations • configurations • combinations	ANTONYMS • uniformity • sameness • invariance
05	**Piquant** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	दिलचस्प लेकिन पेचीदा / तीखा Pleasantly or provocatively stimulating to the mind; uniquely challenging or intriguing in nature.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of a 'pickled' chili that gives a sharp, provocative flavour—here meaning an engaging, tricky situation.	SYNONYMS • intriguing • fascinating • stimulating	ANTONYMS • mundane • insipid • uninspiring
06	**Vulnerability** NOUN NEGATIVE	संवेदनशीलता / भेद्यता The quality or state of being exposed to the possibility of being attacked or harmed, either physically or emotionally.	**MEMORY HOOK** From Latin 'vulnus' (wound)—a state where one is easily wounded or attacked.	SYNONYMS • susceptibility • fragility • weakness	ANTONYMS • invulnerability • resilience • fortitude

07	**Abate** VERB POSITIVE	कम होना / घटना To become less intense, severe, or widespread; to diminish in degree.	**MEMORY HOOK** Rhymes with 'rebate'—a rebate reduces the price, while abate reduces the intensity.	SYNONYMS • subside • diminish • dwindle	ANTONYMS • intensify • escalate • surge
08	**Hamstrung** VERB NEGATIVE	बाधित / लाचार बना दिया Severely restricted the efficiency, movement, or effectiveness of someone or something.	**MEMORY HOOK** If your 'hamstring' muscle is torn, you are disabled and completely unable to run.	SYNONYMS • handicapped • hindered • incapacitated	ANTONYMS • empowered • aided • liberated
09	**Picturesque** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	चित्रमय / दर्शनीय Visually attractive in a charming, scenic, and quaint manner suitable for a painting.	**MEMORY HOOK** Looks exactly like a 'picture' that is so charming you want to frame it.	SYNONYMS • scenic • charming • panoramic	ANTONYMS • unsightly • grotesque • drab
10	**Apt** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	उचित / सर्वथा योग्य Appropriate, fitting, or well-suited to the given circumstances.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of 'aptitude'—someone who has the right ability is very 'apt' (suitable) for the role.	SYNONYMS • appropriate • fitting • suitable	ANTONYMS • inapt • unsuitable • inappropriate
11	**Pedigreed** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रतिष्ठित / उच्च कुल या पृष्ठभूमि वाला Having an established, distinguished background, lineage, or proven record of excellence.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of royal pedigree pets that have an immaculate, proven family record.	SYNONYMS • distinguished • illustrious • accomplished	ANTONYMS • unheralded • undistinguished • ignoble
12	**Ignominy** NOUN NEGATIVE	बदनामी / अपमान Public shame, disgrace, or deep humiliation resulting from poor conduct or defeat.	**MEMORY HOOK** Ig (negative) + nom (name) -> spoiling your good name brings public disgrace.	SYNONYMS • humiliation • disgrace • opprobrium	ANTONYMS • honour • prestige • glory
13	**Wrest** VERB POSITIVE	छीन लेना / संघर्ष करके हासिल करना To forcibly pull or obtain something from someone's grasp through intense effort or struggle.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'wrestle'—you have to wrestle hard with an opponent to pull the prize away.	SYNONYMS • snatch • seize • extract	ANTONYMS • relinquish • concede • yield

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · DRAWN TO DEFEAT: ON INDIA'S CHANCES IN THE ICC WORLD TEST CHAMPIONSHIP

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	**Throwback** NOUN NEUTRAL	पुरानी याद ताजा करने वाला / पूर्व लक्षण A person or thing that bears a striking resemblance to something from an earlier era.	**MEMORY HOOK** Literally something that 'throws' your mind 'back' to an earlier era.	SYNONYMS • reversion • reminiscence • atavism	ANTONYMS • innovation • modernity • novelty
02	**Immovable** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	अटल / अविचल Unable or refusing to be moved; steadfastly resilient against pressure.	**MEMORY HOOK** Im (not) + movable = completely unable to be moved or displaced by the opposition.	SYNONYMS • unshakeable • resolute • unyielding	ANTONYMS • flexible • pliant • wavering

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

2 TERMS

01	**Bid for** NOUN NEUTRAL	प्रयास करना / दावेदारी An earnest attempt or effort made to achieve, secure, or win something.	**MEMORY HOOK** In an auction, your 'bid for' an item is your serious attempt to win it.	SYNONYMS • attempt at • pursuit of • endeavour towards	ANTONYMS • surrender of • withdrawal from • renunciation of
02	**Hinged on** VERB NEUTRAL	पर निर्भर होना Depended entirely on a particular person, condition, or factor to succeed.	**MEMORY HOOK** A door completely relies and turns on its metal 'hinge' to open or close.	SYNONYMS • depended on • pivoted on • rested upon	ANTONYMS • detached from • freed from • independent of

PHRASAL VERBS

2 TERMS

01	**Cropping up** VERB NEUTRAL	अचानक प्रकट होना Appearing, happening, or arising unexpectedly or without advance notice.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like farm 'crops' suddenly growing out of the soil overnight without being noticed.	**SYNONYMS** • emerging • surfacing • materialising	**ANTONYMS** • disappearing • vanishing • subsiding
02	**Turned out** VERB NEUTRAL	मैदान में उतरे / भाग लिया Took part in a sporting match or assembled for an event.	**MEMORY HOOK** You 'turn' around and step 'out' into the open stadium ground to play.	**SYNONYMS** • participated • featured • represented	**ANTONYMS** • withdrew • abstained • sat out

IDIOMS & PHRASES

2 TERMS

01	**Clean sweep** NOUN POSITIVE	पूरी जीत / सूपड़ा साफ A decisive victory in which one contestant or team wins all available matches, contests, or prizes.	**MEMORY HOOK** Imagine a broom completely 'sweeping' every single crumb away—leaving nothing behind for the opponent.	**SYNONYMS** • whitewash • total triumph • landslide victory	**ANTONYMS** • total defeat • whitewash defeat • rout
02	**Down Under** ADVERB NEUTRAL	ऑस्ट्रेलिया या न्यूजीलैंड An informal term referring to Australia and New Zealand due to their position in the southern hemisphere.	**MEMORY HOOK** On a traditional world globe, Australia is positioned all the way 'down under' the equator.	**SYNONYMS** • Australasia • Antipodes • Oceania	**ANTONYMS**

FOREIGN WORDS

1 TERMS

01	**Angst** NOUN NEGATIVE	गहरी चिंता / बेचैनी A deep feeling of persistent anxiety, dread, or apprehension, often about condition and change.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'anxious' + 'agony'—a deep state of internal worry about uncertain transitions.	**SYNONYMS** • apprehension • trepidation • unease	**ANTONYMS** • serenity • calmness • tranquillity

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY & CLIMATE CHANGE

As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge

> *Urgent regional cooperation and resilient infrastructure are essential to mitigate escalating Himalayan glacial disasters.*

August 31, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Himalayan mountain system is the ecological **mainstay**[1] of large parts of the Indian Subcontinent. It is the **wellspring**[2] of rivers and shapes the monsoon. Its forests support biodiversity, and the region is home to several pilgrimage centres. However, the range has become increasingly **fragile**[3] in recent years. The **mounting**[4] toll of the flash floods that struck Nepal last week after a glacier collapse near the country's border with China sent torrents of water down the Bhote Koshi River is a grim reminder of the region's **precarity**[5]. It **underscores**[6] how a disturbance in higher altitudes can swiftly become a downstream **catastrophe**[7].

Several studies, including IPCC reports, have documented the **retreat**[8] of glaciers in the rapidly warming Himalaya. The meltwater accumulates in glacial lakes, many of which are held back by unstable dams of boulders. These lakes can suddenly burst, sending enormous volumes of water and debris down narrow valleys. Landslides, avalanches and **erratic**[9] rainfall can trigger **cascading**[10] events. The Nepal disaster appears to have involved an ice-and-rock avalanche. It is not an isolated incident. A glacial lake outburst in Nepal's Everest region led to massive flooding two years ago. A 2021 study

VOCABULARY 101

1	**mainstay** (Noun)	backbone • मुख्य आधार
2	**wellspring** (Noun)	fountainhead • मूल स्रोत
3	**fragile** (Adjective)	delicate • नाजुक / भंगुर
4	**mounting** (Adjective)	increasing • बढ़ता हुआ
5	**precarity** (Noun)	insecurity • डांवाडोल स्थिति / अनिश्चितता
6	**underscores** (Verb)	emphasises • रेखांकित करना / बल देना
7	**catastrophe** (Noun)	disaster • महाविपत्ति / तबाही
8	**retreat** (Noun)	shrinkage • पीछे हटना / सिकुड़ना
9	**erratic** (Adjective)	unpredictable • अनियमित / अप्रत्याशित

by scientists from IIT Roorkee, IISc Bengaluru, University of Dayton, University of Graz, and the Universities of Zurich and Geneva **flagged**[11] instability around South Lhonak Lake in Sikkim. The warning went largely **unheeded**[12] — the lake burst two years later, killing at least 50 people.

The expansion of roads, hydropower schemes and tourism facilities in the valleys has added another layer of risk. Such projects are necessary for livelihoods, energy security and connectivity. But infrastructure development must **factor in**[13] the **idiosyncrasies**[14] of mountain ecology. Environmental assessments must account for the **cumulative**[15] risks from infrastructure projects, while construction standards must reflect the requirements of an unstable landscape. Glaciers need continuous monitoring, with information shared across borders because Himalayan rivers and hazards do not respect political boundaries. Some efforts are **underway**[16]. India is **accelerating**[17] early-warning systems for the region's lakes, while Nepal and China share information on Himalayan ecology. But last week's disaster is a **stark**[18] reminder of how much more needs to be done. The Bhote Koshi's warning system, designed to track the gradual movement of glacial water, could not detect the sudden **surge**[19] of debris. The experience of Switzerland, where advance monitoring and evacuation helped limit casualties after a glacier collapse destroyed much of the Blatten region in 2025, offers useful lessons. The geology of the Alps and Himalaya is, of course, vastly different. Even then, the **salience**[20] of sharing expertise across mountainous regions cannot be **understated**[21]. These **imperatives**[22] must now be integrated into technology transfer programmes under climate pacts.

Source: **The Indian Express**

Published: **August 31, 2026 06:00 AM IST**

10 **cascading** (Adjective)
successive • सिलसिलेवार / एक के बाद एक

11 **flagged** (Verb)
signalled • चेतावनी देना / चिन्हित करना

12 **unheeded** (Adjective)
ignored • अनसुना / उपेक्षित

13 **factor in** (Verb)
include • शामिल करना / ध्यान में रखना

14 **idiosyncrasies** (Noun)
peculiarities • विशिष्ट लक्षण / विचित्रताएँ

15 **cumulative** (Adjective)
accumulative • संचयी / कुल मिलाकर

16 **underway** (Adjective)
in progress • प्रगति पर / जारी

17 **accelerating** (Verb)
speeding up • गति तेज़ करना

18 **stark** (Adjective)
unpleasant and clear • कठोर / बिल्कुल स्पष्ट

19 **surge** (Noun)
sudden rush • अचानक उफान / तीव्र बहाव

20 **salience** (Noun)
prominence • प्रमुखता / महत्ता

21 **understated** (Verb)
downplayed • कम आंकना

22 **imperatives** (Noun)
necessities • अनिवार्य प्राथमिकताएँ / बाध्यताएँ

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: As glaciers melt, prepare for a Himalayan challenge

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY & CLIMATE CHANGE

EDITORIAL STANCE

ADMONITORY / CAUTIONARY

"warning of mounting dangers"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author adopts a cautionary and urgent tone to emphasize the escalating vulnerability of the Himalayan ecosystem due to rapid glacial melting. By citing recent catastrophic flash floods in Nepal and Sikkim, the editorial highlights the dangerous lag in institutional response and the hazards posed by unbridled infrastructure expansion. It strongly advocates for integrated transboundary early-warning networks, strict ecological building standards, and cross-border scientific collaboration.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

16 WORDS

01	**mainstay** NOUN POSITIVE	मुख्य आधार A chief foundation or essential supporting component of a system.	**MEMORY HOOK** MAIN + STAY = the main pillar that makes a structure stay upright.	**SYNONYMS** • cornerstone • pillar • bulwark	**ANTONYMS** • hindrance • destabiliser • appendage
02	**fragile** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	नाज़ुक / भंगुर Easily damaged, broken, or disrupted; vulnerable to harm.	**MEMORY HOOK** Rhymes with 'agile'; fragile things break easily when handled without care.	**SYNONYMS** • vulnerable • precarious • brittle	**ANTONYMS** • resilient • robust • durable
03	**mounting** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	बढ़ता हुआ Gradually growing larger in quantity, extent, or intensity.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like climbing a MOUNTain, mounting numbers keep going higher and higher.	**SYNONYMS** • escalating • accumulating • intensifying	**ANTONYMS** • diminishing • dwindling • subsiding
04	**underscores** VERB NEUTRAL	रेखांकित करना / बल देना Stresses, emphasizes, or highlights the importance of a fact.	**MEMORY HOOK** Drawing an 'under-score' (underline) beneath a sentence to emphasize it.	**SYNONYMS** • accentuates • underlines • reinforces	**ANTONYMS** • downplays • belittles • glosses over

05	**catastrophe** NOUN NEGATIVE	महाविपत्ति / तबाही An event causing great and often sudden damage or suffering.	**MEMORY HOOK** CATA (downwards) + STROPHE (turn) = an extreme downturn causing great ruin.	**SYNONYMS** • calamity • cataclysm • devastation	**ANTONYMS** • godsend • boon • triumph
06	**retreat** NOUN NEGATIVE	पीछे हटना / सिकुड़ना The process of receding or diminishing in size or coverage over time.	**MEMORY HOOK** Re-TREAT means stepping back or receding from a previous front.	**SYNONYMS** • recession • regression • shrinkage	**ANTONYMS** • advance • expansion • progression
07	**erratic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनियमित / अप्रत्याशित Not even or regular in pattern or movement; wildly unpredictable.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'error'; behaviour full of errors is erratic and inconsistent.	**SYNONYMS** • capricious • unstable • fluctuating	**ANTONYMS** • consistent • steady • predictable
08	**cascading** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सिलसिलेवार / एक के बाद एक Passing down or triggering a sequence of successive stages or consequences.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like a waterfall (cascade) where one drop pushes the next in a sequence.	**SYNONYMS** • sequential • domino-like • consequential	**ANTONYMS** • isolated • independent • discrete
09	**flagged** VERB NEUTRAL	चेतावनी देना / चिन्हित करना Identified or drew attention to information for consideration or caution.	**MEMORY HOOK** Waving a red flag to draw attention to an impending danger.	**SYNONYMS** • highlighted • earmarked • indicated	**ANTONYMS** • overlooked • concealed • ignored
10	**unheeded** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनसुना / उपेक्षित Heard or noticed but completely disregarded or not acted upon.	**MEMORY HOOK** Un- (not) + Heeded (paid attention to) = disregarded.	**SYNONYMS** • disregarded • neglected • dismissed	**ANTONYMS** • heeded • observed • respected
11	**cumulative** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	संचयी / कुल मिलाकर Increasing or building up by successive additions over time.	**MEMORY HOOK** Relate to 'accumulate'; things that add up step by step.	**SYNONYMS** • aggregate • collective • amassed	**ANTONYMS** • fractional • individual • isolated
12	**accelerating** VERB POSITIVE	गति तेज़ करना Increasing the rate, tempo, or speed of an operation or process.	**MEMORY HOOK** Pressing the accelerator pedal makes a vehicle move faster.	**SYNONYMS** • expediting • quickening • hastening	**ANTONYMS** • decelerating • retarding • delaying
13	**stark** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठोर / बिल्कुल स्पष्ट Severe, blunt, or harsh in appearance or reality; unmistakably obvious.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of 'Stark' reality—bare, cold, and impossible to hide.	**SYNONYMS** • uncompromising • grim • blunt	**ANTONYMS** • mild • vague • subtle
14	**surge** NOUN NEGATIVE	अचानक उफान / तीव्र बहाव A sudden and powerful forward or upward movement.	**MEMORY HOOK** SURGE sounds like 'submerge' — a sudden water surge can submerge low areas.	**SYNONYMS** • spate • deluge • rush	**ANTONYMS** • ebb • retreat • subsidence
15	**salience** NOUN POSITIVE	प्रमुखता / महत्ता The quality of being particularly noticeable, important, or prominent.	**MEMORY HOOK** A 'salient' feature stands out prominently from the rest.	**SYNONYMS** • prominence • significance • conspicuousness	**ANTONYMS** • inconsequentiality • insignificance • obscurity
16	**understated** VERB NEUTRAL	कम आंकना Described or represented as being smaller or less important than it actually is.	**MEMORY HOOK** To 'under-state' is to state something as less than its true magnitude.	**SYNONYMS** • minimised • downplayed • undervalued	**ANTONYMS** • exaggerated • overstated • magnified

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · AS GLACIERS MELT, PREPARE FOR A HIMALAYAN CHALLENGE

PART 02

📝 ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

4 TERMS

01	**wellspring** NOUN POSITIVE	**मूल स्रोत** An abundant source or continuous origin of something.	**MEMORY HOOK** A 'spring' of water from a deep 'well' serves as the ultimate source of a river.	**SYNONYMS** • provenance • origin • cradle	**ANTONYMS** • drain • sink • terminus
02	**precarity** NOUN NEGATIVE	**डांवाडोल स्थिति / अनिश्चितता** A state of persistent danger, instability, or uncertainty.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think 'PRE-CARE-ITY' — a situation so risky that you must take care beforehand.	**SYNONYMS** • perilousness • instability • hazardousness	**ANTONYMS** • solidity • security • steadfastness
03	**idiosyncrasies** NOUN NEUTRAL	**विशिष्ट लक्षण / विचित्रताएँ** Distinctive or unique characteristics peculiar to an entity or environment.	**MEMORY HOOK** IDIO (distinct/personal) + SYNCRASY (mixing) = distinct, unique characteristics.	**SYNONYMS** • eccentricities • peculiarities • quirks	**ANTONYMS** • conformities • commonalities • uniformities
04	**imperatives** NOUN POSITIVE	**अनिवार्य प्राथमिकताएँ / बाध्यताएँ** Essential, urgent, or indispensable obligations that require immediate action.	**MEMORY HOOK** It is 'imperative' (vital) that you follow compulsory rules.	**SYNONYMS** • prerequisites • necessities • exigencies	**ANTONYMS** • options • trivialities • luxuries

⚡ PHRASAL VERBS

1 TERMS

01	**factor in** VERB NEUTRAL	**शामिल करना / ध्यान में रखना** To include a particular fact or circumstance when making an assessment or plan.	**MEMORY HOOK** Include every single 'factor' in your calculation.	**SYNONYMS** • incorporate • allow for • take into account	**ANTONYMS** • exclude • omit • discount

🎭 IDIOMS & PHRASES

1 TERMS

01	**underway** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	**प्रगति पर / जारी** Currently in progress, happening, or being carried out.	**MEMORY HOOK** The ship is 'under its way', meaning it has started its journey.	**SYNONYMS** • ongoing • afoot • in motion	**ANTONYMS** • halted • stalled • terminated

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

● TECHNOLOGY & DIGITAL REGULATION

Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability

> “ *US regulatory settlement mandates platform accountability rather than relying solely on parental vigilance.*

📅 August 31, 2026 · ⏱ 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The settlement between Meta and 29 US states over the harm its platforms can cause children is a **veiled**[1] **admission**[2] of a truth that Big Tech has spent years resisting: That these platforms are built to capture attention, and therefore have a **responsibility towards**[3] how they affect young users. Meta will pay up to $18 billion over a decade and introduce a series of restrictions on Facebook and Instagram, including two-hour daily limits for under-18 users, a midnight-to-6-am curfew, stronger age verification mechanisms, default safety settings, and reduced notifications during school hours. The company has denied wrongdoing, and the settlement **leaves untouched**[4] some of the more fundamental questions about personalised recommendations and the advertising-driven business model. Even so, it marks a significant step towards recognising that children's safety can no longer be treated as a matter of self-control or parental **vigilance**[5], that product design itself should come under regulatory **scrutiny**[6].

That is the direction that global regulation has been increasingly **moving towards**[7]. There is a recognition of the fact that these platforms are built to

★ VOCABULARY 101

1	**veiled** (Adjective)	disguised • प्रच्छन्न / छिपा हुआ
2	**admission** (Noun)	acknowledgement • स्वीकारोक्ति
3	**responsibility towards** (Phrase)	duty to • के प्रति उत्तरदायित्व
4	**leaves untouched** (Phrase)	ignores • अनछुआ छोड़ देना / अनदेखा करना
5	**vigilance** (Noun)	watchfulness • सतर्कता / निगरानी
6	**scrutiny** (Noun)	inspection • बारीक जांच / छानबीन
7	**moving towards** (Phrasal verb)	advancing to • की दिशा में आगे बढ़ना
8	**infinite scroll** (Noun)	endless feed • अंतहीन स्क्रॉलिंग प्रणाली
9	**hooks** (Noun)	traps • आकर्षक फंदे / प्रलोभन

make stopping difficult — the **infinite scroll**[8] ensures recommendations continuously supply the next piece of content; notifications and other "**hooks**[9]" are designed to bring users back; likes, streaks and personalised feeds turn attention into a measurable **commodity**[10]. They are features of an engagement economy in which time spent is valuable because attention can be **monetised**[11]. Technology companies have long pushed much of the **responsibility towards**[3] parents who must monitor screen time and users who must exercise self-control. The new **curbs**[13] begin to **move responsibility upstream**[14], towards the companies that build and profit from systems **engineered**[15] to resist **disengagement**[16].

The American settlement offers a useful model for India as it **contemplates**[17] regulation around children's social-media usage. A system **reliant solely on**[18] parental supervision will inevitably leave protection **uneven**[19], depending on digital literacy, time, and household resources. Regulation should instead ask harder questions of the platforms: Why should an engagement-maximising feed be the default for a child? Why should a young user have to **opt out of**[20] personalisation rather than have a safer feed by default? And why should the **burden**[21] of resisting an infinite stream of content fall on the user rather than on the company that created it? Meta's US deal could mark the beginning of a broader effort to **redraw the boundaries of**[22] responsibility.

Source: The Indian Express

Published: August 31, 2026 06:05 AM IST

10	**commodity** (Noun)	trade product	पण्य वस्तु / व्यापारिक उत्पाद
11	**monetised** (Verb)	commercialised	मुद्रीकृत / धनोपार्जन में परिवर्तित
12	**pushed towards** (Phrasal verb)	shifted onto	की ओर धकेलना / थोपना
13	**curbs** (Noun)	restrictions	अंकुश / पाबंदियां
14	**move responsibility upstream** (Phrase)	tackle source	जिम्मेदारी को मूल स्रोत पर स्थानांतरित करना
15	**engineered** (Verb)	designed	योजनाबद्ध रूप से निर्मित
16	**disengagement** (Noun)	detachment	अलगाव / अलग होने की प्रक्रिया
17	**contemplates** (Verb)	considers	विचार करना / चिंतन करना
18	**reliant solely on** (Phrase)	dependent only on	पूरी तरह से पर निर्भर
19	**uneven** (Adjective)	inconsistent	असमान / असंगत
20	**opt out of** (Phrasal verb)	withdraw from	से बाहर निकलने का विकल्प चुनना
21	**burden** (Noun)	heavy load	बोझ / उत्तरदायित्व का भार
22	**redraw the boundaries of** (Phrase)	redefine limits of	की सीमाओं को पुनर्परिभाषित करना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability

THE INDIAN EXPRESS **TECHNOLOGY & DIGITAL REGULATION**

EDITORIAL STANCE

ANALYTICAL

"examining issues methodically"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author critically evaluates Meta's multi-billion-dollar legal settlement with US states, arguing that algorithmic feeds and monetised attention structurally foster juvenile addiction. By highlighting that individual self-control cannot counter addictive design, the editorial advocates for robust, platform-centric regulation in developing markets like India.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

11 WORDS

01	**veiled** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	प्रच्छन्न / छिपा हुआ Expressed in an indirect, partially concealed, or disguised manner.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of a bridal 'veil' that covers or conceals the face from direct view.	**SYNONYMS** • disguised • masked • covert	**ANTONYMS** • overt • explicit • unconcealed
02	**admission** NOUN NEUTRAL	स्वीकारोक्ति A statement acknowledging the truth of something, often done reluctantly.	**MEMORY HOOK** When you 'admit' an error into your mind, you make an admission.	**SYNONYMS** • acknowledgement • concession • confession	**ANTONYMS** • denial • refusal • repudiation
03	**vigilance** NOUN POSITIVE	सतर्कता / निगरानी The state of keeping careful watch for possible dangers or difficulties.	**MEMORY HOOK** A 'vigilante' stays awake at night with keen 'vigilance' to watch for danger.	**SYNONYMS** • watchfulness • alertness • circumspection	**ANTONYMS** • negligence • carelessness • inattention
04	**scrutiny** NOUN NEUTRAL	बारीक जांच / छानबीन Critical observation, thorough examination, or close surveillance.	**MEMORY HOOK** To screw in a tiny part, you need close 'scrutiny' and sharp observation.	**SYNONYMS** • inspection • investigation • examination	**ANTONYMS** • neglect • oversight • inattention

05	**hooks** NOUN NEGATIVE	**आकर्षक फंदे / प्रलोभन** Features or techniques deliberately designed to captivate and trap attention.	**MEMORY HOOK** A fishing 'hook' catches the fish by luring it with attractive bait.	**SYNONYMS** • enticements • snares • attractions	**ANTONYMS** • deterrents • repellants • disincentives
06	**monetised** VERB NEUTRAL	**मुद्रीकृत / धनोपार्जन में परिवर्तित** Converted an activity, asset, or audience engagement into commercial profit.	**MEMORY HOOK** Convert into 'money' -> 'monetise'.	**SYNONYMS** • commercialised • capitalised • profitised	**ANTONYMS** • decommercialised • demonetised • subsidised
07	**curbs** NOUN NEUTRAL	**अंकुश / पाबंदियां** Checks, restraints, or official limits placed upon an activity or behaviour.	**MEMORY HOOK** A road 'curb' stops vehicles from driving off the street, acting as a restraint.	**SYNONYMS** • restraints • restrictions • constraints	**ANTONYMS** • incentives • allowances • freedoms
08	**engineered** VERB NEUTRAL	**योजनाबद्ध रूप से निर्मित** Deliberately designed, constructed, or manipulated to achieve a specific result.	**MEMORY HOOK** An 'engineer' deliberately crafts and plans complex structures with precision.	**SYNONYMS** • designed • contrived • manufactured	**ANTONYMS** • improvised • unplanned • spontaneous
09	**contemplates** VERB NEUTRAL	**विचार करना / चिंतन करना** Looks at thoughtfully or considers an action thoroughly over a period of time.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sitting quietly in a 'temple' to deeply meditate and 'contemplate' life choices.	**SYNONYMS** • deliberates • ponders • envisages	**ANTONYMS** • ignores • disregards • rejects
10	**uneven** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	**असमान / असंगत** Not uniform, fair, or well-balanced across different segments or groups.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Un' (not) + 'even' (equal) = lacking balance and uniformity.	**SYNONYMS** • disparate • irregular • inconsistent	**ANTONYMS** • uniform • equitable • consistent
11	**burden** NOUN NEGATIVE	**बोझ / उत्तरदायित्व का भार** A heavy load, demanding responsibility, or distressing obligation.	**MEMORY HOOK** A 'burden' feels like bearing a heavy bag that burns your back.	**SYNONYMS** • onus • encumbrance • liability	**ANTONYMS** • relief • advantage • boon

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · META'S US DEAL REDRAWS LINE OF ACCOUNTABILITY

PART 02

📝 ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

3 TERMS

01	**infinite scroll** NOUN NEGATIVE	**अंतहीन स्क्रॉलिंग प्रणाली** A web-design technique that loads content continuously as the user scrolls down.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Infinite' means endless; continuously rolling a parchment without reaching the end.	**SYNONYMS** • continuous scrolling • perpetual feed • endless pagination	**ANTONYMS** • paginated interface • finite layout • page break
02	**commodity** NOUN NEUTRAL	**पण्य वस्तु / व्यापारिक उत्पाद** A raw material, product, or service that can be bought, sold, or traded.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Common' goods bought and sold in quantity are known as commodities.	**SYNONYMS** • merchandise • product • good	**ANTONYMS** • intangible • non-commercial item • unmarketable asset
03	**disengagement** NOUN NEUTRAL	**अलगाव / अलग होने की प्रक्रिया** The act or process of withdrawing from an involvement, platform, or relationship.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Dis' (removal) + 'engagement' (involvement) = breaking free from an attachment.	**SYNONYMS** • detachment • withdrawal • disconnection	**ANTONYMS** • involvement • absorption • engagement

🔗 FIXED PREPOSITIONS

2 TERMS

01	**responsibility towards** PHRASE POSITIVE	**के प्रति उत्तरदायित्व** Having an ethical or legal obligation of care aimed at a specific entity.	**MEMORY HOOK** Directing one's 'response' and duty 'towards' a target group or obligation.	**SYNONYMS** • accountability to • obligation to • duty to	**ANTONYMS** • unaccountability to • disregard for • negligence of
02	**reliant solely on** PHRASE NEGATIVE	**पूरी तरह से पर निर्भर** Exclusively dependent on a single source or mechanism for support or function.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Rely on' means to depend upon; adding 'solely' restricts it entirely to one pillar.	**SYNONYMS** • dependent solely on • contingent exclusively up • resting entirely on	**ANTONYMS** • independent of • unreliant on • autonomous from

⚡ PHRASAL VERBS

3 TERMS

01	**moving towards** PHRASAL VERB NEUTRAL	की दिशा में आगे बढ़ना Progressing or shifting in the direction of a specific goal or state.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Moving' step-by-step 'towards' a designated target.	**SYNONYMS** • progressing to • gravitating towards • advancing to	**ANTONYMS** • retreating from • diverging from • regressing from
02	**pushed towards** PHRASAL VERB NEGATIVE	की ओर धकेलना / थोपना Transferred an onerous burden or responsibility onto another party.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Pushing' a heavy load 'towards' someone else to avoid carrying it yourself.	**SYNONYMS** • shunted onto • offloaded onto • deflected towards	**ANTONYMS** • shouldered • assumed • absorbed
03	**opt out of** PHRASAL VERB NEUTRAL	से बाहर निकलने का विकल्प चुनना To choose formally not to participate in or be included in an activity or system.	**MEMORY HOOK** Make an 'option' to go 'out' of a scheme.	**SYNONYMS** • decline • withdraw from • renege on	**ANTONYMS** • opt into • subscribe to • participate in

🎭 IDIOMS & PHRASES

3 TERMS

01	**leaves untouched** PHRASE NEGATIVE	अनछुआ छोड़ देना / अनदेखा करना Fails to address, alter, or resolve a fundamental issue.	**MEMORY HOOK** If your hands never 'touch' a chore, it remains completely unaddressed.	**SYNONYMS** • bypasses • overlooks • neglects	**ANTONYMS** • addresses • confronts • remedies
02	**move responsibility upstream** PHRASE POSITIVE	जिम्मेदारी को मूल स्रोत पर स्थानांतरित करना Shifting accountability to the original creators and structural source of a problem.	**MEMORY HOOK** Fixing river pollution at the 'upstream' spring rather than downstream at the mouth.	**SYNONYMS** • address root causes • shift accountability to sou • fix origin	**ANTONYMS** • shift blame downstream • pass the buck • target symptoms
03	**redraw the boundaries of** PHRASE POSITIVE	की सीमाओं को पुनर्परिभाषित करना To fundamentally revise and redefine the established limits, scope, or terms of something.	**MEMORY HOOK** Erasing old borders on a map to 'redraw' modern, fairer boundary lines.	**SYNONYMS** • redefine the limits of • restructure the scope • reframe the terms of	**ANTONYMS** maintain the status quo of • preserve the boundaries of • entrench the limits of

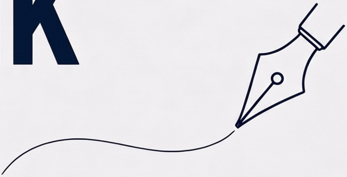
TODAY'S EDITORIALS

ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY

★

📅 AUGUST 31, 2026

THANK YOU!



FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.

FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam. ❤️📚✨

If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

> Just keep in mind one thing,
> ***"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies... The man who never reads lives only one."***

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☑ Learn
☑ Succeed
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ENVIRONMENT
ECONOMY
HISTORY
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Prathu

— EST 21.07.2025 —

RELEVANT EDITORAILS
Handpicked Daily

VOCABULARY LIST
Multiple Synonyms, Tone & Part of Speech

SMARTER PREPARATION
Better Understanding

STRONGER RESULTS
Achieve Your Goal

KEEP READING. KEEP GROWING. KEEP ACHIEVING. 📚✨